CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

# STUDY MATERIALS - 19

PART 1

## Listening to Problem Solving

**Question 1 of 8:** Choose the best answer to each question.

- His tomatoes are not growing well.
- Some of his plants are disappearing.
- His gardening tools have been stolen.
- Someone's been eating his raspberries.

**Question 2 of 8:** Choose the best answer to each question.

- She is unsurprised.
- She is alarmed.
- She does not believe him.
- She is confused.

**Question 3 of 8:** Choose the best answer to each question.

- She is suggesting he grow something else.
- She thinks they are the best for cooking.
- She's trying to make the man feel better.
- She wants to share a green salsa recipe.

**Question 4 of 8:** Choose the best answer to each question.

- It makes them taste better.
- It makes them ripen quickly.
- It makes them grow bigger.
- It makes them look strange.

**Question 5 of 8:** Choose the best answer to each question.

- put up another warning sign
- stop growing red tomatoes
- make his tomatoes seem toxic
- make some green tomato salsa

**Question 6 of 8:** Choose the best answer to each question

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-
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-

**Question 7 of 8:** Choose the best answer to each question.

- put out a wire trap to catch any pests
- put up a protective wooden fence
- replace the existing wire fence
- repair the wire mesh around his tomatoes

**Question 8 of 8:** Choose the best answer to each question

- safety
- appearance
- seed quality
- water quality

PART 2

## Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

**Question 1 of 5:** Choose the best answer.

- ◯ to arrange a work lunch
- ◯ to discuss job listings
- ◯ to offer him a position
- ◯ to tell him about a job

**Question 2 of 5:** Choose the best answer.

- ◯ make a career change
- ◯ get a promotion
- ◯ make more money
- ◯ study for a new license

**Question 3 of 5:** Choose the best answer.

- ◯ lunch breaks
- ◯ office location
- ◯ parking lots
- ◯ employee training

**Question 4 of 5:** Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He is buying a car to commute.
- ◯ It could be a major expense.
- ◯ The cost isn't mentioned in the posting.
- ◯ The man asked about availability.

**Question 5 of 5:** Choose the best answer.

- ◯ get his realtor's license
- ◯ research the agency
- ◯ respond to the ad
- ◯ take the woman to lunch

PART 3

## Listening for Information

**Question 1 of 6:** Choose the best answer.

- ◯ because his apartment building doesn't allow pets
- ◯ because he's never owned an aquarium before
- ◯ because they are easier to care for than other animals
- ◯ because he loved having tropical fish as a child

**Question 2 of 6:** Choose the best answer

- ◯ a tank that holds more water
- ◯ a tank that holds salt water
- ◯ a tank that holds less water
- ◯ a tank that holds cooler water

**Question 3 of 6:** Choose the best answer.

- ◯ because the water requires special chemicals
- ◯ because they require constant cleaning
- ◯ because they need more specialized equipment
- ◯ because they are usually very big tanks

**Question 4 of 6:** Choose the best answer.

- ◯ because they are less expensive in the long run
- ◯ because they require less additional equipment
- ◯ because it is his first time caring for a fish tank
- ◯ because she thinks he'll appreciate it more

**Question 5 of 6:** Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He thinks coral is easier to look after.
- ◯ He thinks coral is beautiful to look at.
- ◯ He thinks coral helps keep the tank warm.
- ◯ He thinks coral keeps the fish healthy.

**Question 6 of 6:** Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He will need to buy a special pump.
- ◯ He will need to get an installation service.
- ◯ He will need to get sand for the aquarium.
- ◯ He will need to get vitamins for the fish.

PART 4

## Listening to a News Item

1. Edward O'Reilly _____
- ◯ rarely rearranges his office furniture.
- ◯ often repairs his own furniture.
- ◯ enjoys collecting watercolour artwork.
- ◯ enjoys being surprised.

2. The old filing cabinet _____
- ◯ was preventing proper air ventilation.
- ◯ was hiding a valuable work of art.
- ◯ has been emptied by the janitor.
- ◯ contained valuable documents.

3. The main reason for the press conference was to _____
- ◯ invite the audience to solve a mystery.
- ◯ appraise a piece of artwork at ten thousand dollars.
- ◯ explain the origins of an old filing cabinet.
- ◯ describe the circumstances of a remarkable event.

4. The best headline for this news story would be _____
- ◯ "Masterpiece Re-Emerges at a Local High School."
- ◯ "School Principal Paints Outstanding Artwork in Watercolour."
- ◯ "Filing Cabinets Pose Safety Hazard in School Offices."
- ◯ "Missing Painting Recovered Thanks to Joint Effort."

5. The principal intends to _____
- ◯ sell the painting.
- ◯ offer art classes.
- ◯ become a painter.
- ◯ reward the janitor.

PART 5

## Listening to a Discussion

1. What is the cause of this workplace conflict?
- ◯ differing perspectives
- ◯ stringent rules
- ◯ technical difficulties
- ◯ customer complaints

2. Why does Louise think the washrooms are clean enough?
- ◯ She just went to check them.
- ◯ Someone else just cleaned them.
- ◯ No customers have used them.
- ◯ She has cleaned them recently.

3. Why is Daniel upset?
- ◯ His employees are not serving the customers.
- ◯ His staff doesn't plan on working for him long-term.
- ◯ His employees are providing poor customer service.
- ◯ The bathrooms are being neglected by cleaning staff.

4. How does Louise feel about texting?
- ◯ It's efficient.
- ◯ It's silly.
- ◯ It's private.
- ◯ It's changing.

5. According to Louise, what are young people good at today?
- ◯ managing their time
- ◯ finding out information
- ◯ communicating with others
- ◯ handling their banking

6. Why does Jerry need a good reference?
- ◯ for a promotion at work
- ◯ for a school application
- ◯ to apply for a scholarship
- ◯ to get a better job

PART 5

7. What will probably happen after this conversation?

- ◯ Jerry will find a new reference.
- ◯ Louise will do her banking in person.
- ◯ Louise will finally clean the bathroom.
- ◯ Jerry will be more attentive at work.

8. What is the biggest difference between Daniel and his two employees?

- ◯ willingness to work hard
- ◯ customer service skills
- ◯ communication preferences
- ◯ social life outside of work

PART 6

## Listening for Viewpoints

1. Chang and Dugard seem equally interested in _____

- ◯ alternative approaches.
- ◯ classroom textbooks.
- ◯ grammar structures.
- ◯ language assessment.

2. Lexilearn suits teachers who _____

- ◯ like to plan their lessons in detail.
- ◯ speak English as a second language.
- ◯ succeed at spontaneous activities.
- ◯ work in a school having final exams.

3. What makes Lexilearn different from other approaches?

- ◯ Impromptu speeches are assigned.
- ◯ Students generate learning materials.
- ◯ Teachers listen more attentively.
- ◯ Textbooks are culturally appropriate.

4. The person opposed to Lexilearn believes it is _____

- ◯ simplistic.
- ◯ confusing.
- ◯ ineffective.
- ◯ unethical.

5. Conversational English teacher Madison Chang would likely praise Mark Dugard for _____

- ◯ following lesson plans.
- ◯ encouraging chitchat.
- ◯ revising his textbooks.
- ◯ recording his warmup.

6. Regina College would probably attract students seeking _____

- ◯ self-directed learning regimes.
- ◯ level-headed school administration.
- ◯ native English-speaking teachers.
- ◯ structured classroom learning.

# Answer Key

| PART 1 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | Some of his plants are disappearing. |
| Question 2 | She is unsurprised. |
| Question 3 | She's trying to make the man feel better. |
| Question 4 | It makes them look strange. |
| Question 5 | make his tomatoes seem toxic |
| Question 6 | |
| Question 7 | put up a protective wooden fence |
| Question 8 | appearance |

| PART 2 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | to tell him about a job |
| Question 2 | make a career change |
| Question 3 | office location |
| Question 4 | It could be a major expense. |
| Question 5 | respond to the ad |

| PART 3 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | because he's never owned an aquarium before |
| Question 2 | a tank that holds more water |
| Question 3 | because they need more specialized equipment |
| Question 4 | because she thinks he'll appreciate it more |
| Question 5 | He thinks coral is beautiful to look at. |
| Question 6 | He will need to get sand for the aquarium. |

| PART 4 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | rarely rearranges his office furniture. |
| Question 2 | was hiding a valuable work of art. |
| Question 3 | describe the circumstances of a remarkable event. |
| Question 4 | "Masterpiece Re-Emerges at a Local High School." |
| Question 5 | sell the painting. |

| PART 5 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | differing perspectives |
| Question 2 | She has cleaned them recently. |
| Question 3 | His employees are providing poor customer service. |
| Question 4 | It's efficient. |
| Question 5 | managing their time |
| Question 6 | for a school application |
| Question 7 | Jerry will be more attentive at work. |
| Question 8 | communication preferences |

| PART 6 | |
|---|---|
| Question 1 | alternative approaches. |
| Question 2 | succeed at spontaneous activities. |
| Question 3 | Students generate learning materials. |
| Question 4 | ineffective. |
| Question 5 | encouraging chitchat. |
| Question 6 | structured classroom learning. |

PART 1

# Transcripts

## Listening to Problem Solving

*You are about to hear a conversation between a man and a woman at a community garden. The man recently joined the community garden; the woman is a council member and gardener.*

**Section 1:**

MAN: Hello! I'm Mark.

WOMAN: Hello! I'm Teresa. You're new here, yes? I've been away for a few months, which would explain why we haven't met yet. How's your garden coming along?

MAN: Yes, I'm relatively new. And I'm afraid I'm having some troubles already.

WOMAN: Oh no! What's going on?

MAN: Someone's been stealing my tomatoes!

WOMAN: Oh no! That's so sad. Unfortunately, it's pretty common in a community garden. Sorry to hear that though.

MAN: Any idea who's stealing them?

WOMAN: I have no idea. It's hard to believe it might be a fellow garden member, but you never know! Or sometimes kids like to come through and have a snack. I've caught them eating my raspberries a few times.

MAN: Do you think I should put a sign up?

WOMAN: There's no harm in trying, but to be honest, I doubt a sign will stop anyone.

**Now answer questions 1-2.**

1. What is the man unhappy about?
2. What is the woman's reaction to the man's news?

**Section 2:**

MAN: Hello again!

WOMAN: Hi there! How's the garden?

MAN: Not so good. I put up a sign, but more tomatoes are gone today. I haven't been able to eat a single ripe tomato! Only the green ones are left.

WOMAN: Well, you could pick the green ones and make a green tomato salsa!

MAN: I'm not much of a salsa fan. Do you have any other suggestions?

WOMAN: This is a sneaky one, but you could sprinkle some baking flour on your green tomatoes.

MAN: Baking flour? What good would that do?

WOMAN: People will think it's insecticide or pesticide or something, so they won't want your tomatoes!

MAN: I would never have thought of that! Thanks!

**Now answer questions 3-5.**

3. Why does the woman mention green tomatoes?
4. Why does the woman suggest sprinkling flour on the tomatoes?
5. What is the man likely to do next?

## Transcripts

**Section 3:**

WOMAN: Hey, how are the tomatoes?

MAN: There's a few red ones! The flour trick seems to be working. But I had a new thought. Maybe rabbits are eating my tomatoes.

WOMAN: Hmm. When I think of rabbits in gardens, I think of them eating lettuce and green leafy stuff, but maybe they like tomatoes too.

MAN: Anyway, I decided to put a wire fence around my tomato section, you know, out of that silver chicken wire netting.

WOMAN: Oh, I'm afraid we have a policy against that sort of thing. There was a vote last year and most people said they didn't want—well, they didn't think wire fencing was attractive.

MAN: Oh, really? That's too bad.

WOMAN: How about a wooden fence instead?

MAN: That would be okay. Sure, I'll do that then.

**Now answer questions 6-8.**

6. What does the man think is responsible for his problem?
7. What does the man plan to do?
8. What are many of the community garden members concerned about?

# Transcripts

## Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

*You will hear a phone conversation between a man and a woman.*

WOMAN: Hello, is David there?

MAN: Speaking.

WOMAN: Hi David, this is Sandra. How's it going?

MAN: Not too bad. What's new with you?

WOMAN: Not much. Things are busy at work, but you know me: I like it when there's lots to do. Listen, I saw a job posting today, and I immediately thought of you. I know last month you mentioned you were looking for a career change.

MAN: Thanks for thinking of me. I'd love to check it out. Don't get me wrong, I really enjoy working at the dealership, but ever since I got my realtor's license last year, I've been wanting to make the switch.

WOMAN: Well, the ad says that they're looking for motivated, enthusiastic people, which I think describes you perfectly. It doesn't mention qualifications, and I can't see any details on salary. Oh, here, it says compensation TBD, I guess that means "to be determined."

MAN: Yeah, in real estate sales the salary is usually based on commission. Where is the agency located?

WOMAN: It's right in your neighbourhood. The company is Romnax; you know, the one across the street from Superstore on King Street? Think about it, no more commuting. You would definitely save on gas and parking.

MAN: Well, if it's that close to home, I might as well bike to work everyday and get the exercise! Remember? I need to get my training up to speed for the New Year's bike race.

WOMAN: That's a great idea! And it's always so expensive to park downtown. So, are you going to apply for the job?

MAN: Yeah, I think I will. Can you email me the link? I just updated my resume, so I'll write a cover letter and apply today. Thanks so much for thinking of me!

WOMAN: No problem. But if you get the job, you owe me lunch!

**Now answer questions 1-5.**

1. Why did the woman call the man?
2. What does the man want to do?
3. What detail does the man want to know more about?
4. Why does the woman mention parking?
5. What will the man probably do after the conversation?

PART 3

# Transcripts

## Listening for Information

*You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman at an aquarium supply store.*

WOMAN: Welcome to Aquaworld! How can I help you?

MAN: Hi! I'm interested in purchasing a fish aquarium. I'm an animal lover and I've had all different kinds of pets, but never fish. I've always wanted to try owning my own aquarium.

WOMAN: Well, you've come to the right place! I can certainly help you get started. Now, were you considering a freshwater aquarium, or a saltwater one?

MAN: I've always wanted a saltwater aquarium. I love tropical fish and coral reefs. But I've heard that freshwater tanks are easier for beginners to maintain.

WOMAN: That is generally true. However, it's more the size of your tank setup that will determine how hard it is to take care of.

MAN: Right, I see. A big tank is more difficult to take care of than a little one, of course.

WOMAN: Actually, that's a very common misconception! It sounds strange, but the larger the tank, the easier it is to take care of. This is because a larger volume of water helps to maintain temperature changes and the quality of the water.

MAN: Wow, I didn't know that! Do you think I should get saltwater then?

WOMAN: If you think this is going to be a serious hobby for you, I would get the aquarium you will enjoy most. It sounds like you want a saltwater tank. Now, to be honest with you, saltwater aquariums generally cost more than freshwater ones, because they tend to require additional equipment. If you want living corals, they usually need special lighting.

MAN: I think I will get saltwater. And yes, I'd like corals. They're so colorful! They're actually the main reason I'd prefer saltwater to freshwater. So, in addition to a tank, fish, and corals, what are the basics that I need to buy?

WOMAN: You will need a good filtration system, which continuously cleans the water. You will also need sand for the tank floor, and marine salt to add to the water. Then you need lighting, and a water test kit, and food for the fish of course.

MAN: Okay, sounds good! Would you be able to show me where I could get all these things?

WOMAN: Absolutely. Follow me and we can get started!

**Now answer questions 1-6.**

1. Why does the man want to purchase a fish aquarium?
2. What kind of tank is easier to maintain?
3. Why do saltwater aquariums cost more?
4. Why does the woman suggest the man get a saltwater tank?
5. Why does the man like coral?
6. What else will the man need to get?

# Transcripts

## Listening to a News Item

*You will hear a news item about a surprise at a local high school.*

The principal at a local Winnipeg high school couldn't believe his eyes when he discovered a valuable artifact at work.

Edward O'Reilly has been working at Winnipeg Secondary School for over 15 years, first as an art teacher, and later as its principal. While moving some office furniture last week, O'Reilly discovered a large, beautiful painting hidden behind an old filing cabinet, once used by his predecessor to store school records. The original painting, lushly coloured with bright watercolours, was painted by the expert hand of legendary painter Alejandra Leland. It was later appraised by local art experts to be valued at approximately ten thousand dollars.

Speaking with reporters at a press conference, O'Reilly recalled why he was rearranging his office in the first place. He said that the school janitor had asked him to move the filing cabinet so that he could reach the ceiling vent and do a quick repair. O'Reilly was extremely surprised to find the treasure since he does spring cleaning of his office each year. However, he never thought to look behind the old filing cabinet. The discovery is opportune as now the school has resources to add music to their curriculum.

# Transcripts

## Listening to a Discussion

*You will watch a discussion among three people, two men and one woman, at a gas station office. They are dealing with an issue at their workplace.*

Daniel: Hey Jerry, the washrooms need to be cleaned. Do you mind doing it before you take your lunchbreak?

Jerry: Yeah, sure thing . . . just let me finish sending this text message. It hasn't been that busy, so I'm sure they're not that bad.

Louise: Don't worry, Daniel. I did them a couple hours ago, and only a few customers have used them since then. Besides, Jerry's making plans with his girlfriend. You don't want to mess up his weekend, do you?

Daniel: Sometimes I just don't understand your generation . . . all your texting and cellphones; you spend so much time with your faces buried in a screen, that you don't even talk to the people standing right in front of you! When I was a teenager, I would call my girlfriend up, or talk to her face to face! This new age of technology is so impersonal!

Louise: You and my mom would get along great! But times change. We save so much time by texting. We can get things done without wasting time chatting on the phone—it's why our generation is great at multi-tasking!

Jerry: Totally. With texting I can make plans with my girlfriend and help customers at the same time. You cannot do that while you're talking on the phone.

Daniel: Well, let's not forget I didn't hire you to socialize, I hired you to work. When your face is buried in your phone, you can't even see the customers! I know you guys aren't planning to stay here forever, you don't care about promotions, but if you want to get a decent letter of recommendation from me when you decide to move on, you'll put your phones away.

Jerry: Woah. Sorry Daniel . . . I didn't realize it bothered you so much. Listen, I really need this reference for my university application. If I don't get into university, I don't stand much chance of getting my dream job. I'll save the texting for my breaks.

Louise: I don't want to mess up my reference either, but I don't get the problem. We live in a digital world that keeps moving and changing. If you don't stay connected, it's hard to get caught up. I'm not just sending silly texts . . . I'm doing my banking, sending emails, researching information. I really don't see how it interferes with getting my work done . . . but if you insist, I'll put my phone away.

Daniel: Thanks, you two! I may be old fashioned, but so are most of my customers. And I know that they don't appreciate being served by somebody whose focus is more on their phone than on them.

# Transcripts

## Listening for Viewpoints

*You will hear a presentation about a language learning approach.*

Calgary-based English as a Second Language teacher Mark Dugard has pledged to give up his intimate relationship with his ESL textbooks. Dugard has just embarked on an experiment with a radically outside-the-box language teaching approach called Lexilearn English Language Teaching. Lexilearn-style lessons are based on spontaneous, free-flowing, and undirected student conversations. Publishers' textbooks and workbooks are shunned, as are syllabi, course outlines, and even lesson plans. Instead, the learning objectives are inductively derived from whatever language naturally emerges from the students. Lexilearn isn't so much a teaching method as an anti-method.

One Lexilearn devotee is Madison Chang, who teaches conversational English at Toronto's Interglobe Learning Centre. She adopted the Lexilearn approach two years ago and hasn't looked back. In the past, she says, she would slavishly follow the dialogues, stories, and grammar in the textbook, but now she and her students collaboratively create these texts as they emerge from natural conversations. Chang says students are much more engaged with and take greater pride in texts they've authored and grammar they've produced themselves. With Lexilearn, Chang feels more attuned to her students, listening intently to everything they say so that she can tease out narratives and extrapolate relevant grammatical structures. Chang says Lexilearn has made her a more creative and engaged teacher; it forces her to think on her feet.

But Regina College principal Evan Kasowitz derides the Lexilearn approach as nothing more than a dignified term for "winging it." Kasowitz, who trains the school's ESL teachers, notes that the few-and-far-between teachers who succeed with the approach tend to be unusually gifted at making up activities as they go along, even when preparation was obviously needed. Kasowitz also charges that Lexilearn is elitist, because its practitioners must be highly fluent native speakers of English—a rarity among ESL teachers worldwide. And even with an impeccable Lexilearn teacher, the approach still doesn't work with many students: those wanting test preparation, those from cultures where textbooks are seen as giving credibility to the course, and, finally, Kasowitz says with an ominous tone, teenagers. Don't ever try Lexilearn in a large classroom of adolescents, Kasowitz warns. It will fail beyond your worst nightmare.

Happily for Mark Dugard back in Calgary, his classroom is full of adults. Whether or not Lexilearn becomes a permanent fixture in his classroom, Dugard says the first 15 minutes of his class will always be what he calls "not true Lexilearn, but certainly Lexilearn-esque." Starting every class with undirected, voluntary conversation, Dugard says, puts the students at ease and prepares them to learn. But that's not Lexilearn, insists Dugard; it's just a good warmup.